



PHP syntax 30m

How is PHP structured?

The structure of PHP is quite simple. All PHP code appears between the opening tag `<?php` and the closing tag `?>`, like this:

```
<?php  
PHP code goes here  
?>
```



All PHP statements end with a semicolon (;). For example, if we wanted to create a simple PHP file that uses the built-in **echo** function in PHP to print the text 'Hello BIT703' on a web page, we'd use the PHP code below. Take a look at the opening and closing tags, and how the statement ends.



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```
1  <!DOCTYPE html>
2  <html>
3  <body>
4
5  <h1>My first PHP page</h1>
6
7  <?php
8  echo "Hello World!";
9  ?>
10
11 </body>
12 </html>
```



Because PHP is a scripting language that is designed to be embedded into HTML, there can be more than one block of PHP code in a file, interspersed with HTML content. For example:



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```
1  <!DOCTYPE html>
2  <head><title>a php page</title></head>
3  <body>
4      <php
5          Some PHP code here
6      ?>
7      <p>hello I am some HTML content</p>
8      <php
9          Some more PHP here
10     ?>
11 </body>
12 </html>
```



This shows that PHP script can be placed anywhere in an HTML file. The role of PHP in a web page is to dynamically generate content so that the page that gets sent back to the browser from the web server is an HTML page. As mentioned earlier, the pages that contain PHP on the server will have a **.php file extension**, not .html. For example,

myPHPfile.php

The web server will process the file from top to bottom, including any output from the PHP code, into the HTML page that gets sent back to the client browser.

PHP case sensitivity

In PHP, keywords (for example, `if`, `else`, `while`, `echo`), classes, functions and user-defined functions are **not** case-sensitive.

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Variable names, on the other hand, **are** case-sensitive. Variables are used to store information such as values or data. Variables start with a dollar sign (\$) and are followed by the name of the variable. \$colour is an example of a variable.



☒ Case sensitivity

Non-Assessed

Have a look at the code below:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <body>
    <?php
      $colour = "grey";
      echo "My shirt is " . $colour . "<br>";
      echo "My duvet cover is " . $COLOUR . "<br>";
      echo "My car is " . $coLOUR . "<br>";
    ?>
  </body>
</html>
```

Based on what you've just learnt about case sensitivity, what do you think the output of the above code will be? Explain why.

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